Mohammed Mehdi Kaebi

Insper Institute of Education and Research, São Paulo, Brazil

mohammedmk@al.insper.edu.br +55 11 99333 3107 mkaebi.github.io

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Education

Insper (AACSB, EQUIS & AMBA accredited) São Paulo, Brazil
PhD in Economics (Finance research track) 2022–2027
Dissertation: *Essays in Empirical Asset Pricing*
Advisors: Ruy M. Ribeiro and Marco Bonomo

London School of Economics and Political Science London, UK
Visiting Scholar, Financial Markets Group 2025
Host: Christopher Polk. Course audited: Asset Pricing
Research assistance on *Stock Prices Under Pressure: How Tax and Interest Rates Drive Seasonal Variation in Expected Returns*, by Kang, Pekkala, Polk, and Ribeiro

Insper (AACSB, EQUIS & AMBA accredited) São Paulo, Brazil
BSc in Economics 2017–2021
Rank 3 of 111 (GPA 9.31/10.00)

Research Interests

Asset pricing, international finance, financial economics.

References

Marco Bonomo
Professor of Economics
Insper
marcoacb@insper.edu.br

Christopher Polk
Professor of Finance
London School of Economics
c.polk@lse.ac.uk

Ruy M. Ribeiro
Associate Professor of Finance
Insper
ruymr@insper.edu.br

Marcelo Fernandes
Professor of Finance
São Paulo School of Economics - FGV
marcelo.fernandes@fgv.br

Job Market Paper

VIX Futures Term Structure and Currency Returns

I use the VIX futures term-structure to build currency risk factors and show that they are priced in the cross-section of currency returns and help predict currency returns. Currencies with greater exposure to the level and curvature factors earn a lower risk premium, acting as insurance, while those more exposed to the slope factor earn a higher premium, and the premia sit in the variance-risk-premium component, not in news about expected future volatility. A Bayesian factor-selection procedure places the term-structure factors in the stochastic discount factor with high posterior probability. I rationalize these results with a two-agent preferred-habitat model in which experts have horizon-specific volatility hedging demands and arbitrageurs face funding and margin costs, and currency premia depend on each country's share of global hedging demand relative to the US.

Award: Best Paper in Asset Pricing, Brazilian Finance Society Annual Meeting, 2026

Presentations: 32nd AEFIN Finance Forum (Pamplona, 2025, also discussant), 26th Meeting of the Brazilian Finance Society (Fortaleza, 2026), 48th Meeting of the Brazilian Econometric Society (scheduled, Foz do Iguaçu, 2026), Insper Macro and Finance Workshop.

Working Papers

Following the Stars: Long-Run Rates in the Carry Trade, with Igor Martins

Presentations: Insper Macro and Finance Workshop.

Covariance Implied Risk Factors

Presentations: 33rd AEFIN Finance Forum (Alicante, 2026, also discussant), 26th Meeting of the Brazilian Finance Society (Fortaleza, 2026), FinanceHub (São Paulo, 2026), 10th Vietnam International Conference in Finance (accepted, Hanoi, 2026), Insper Macro and Finance Workshop.

Firm Characteristics and Stock Returns in Brazil, with R. Ribeiro, I. Martins, J. Costa, T. Nobrega

Presentations: 24th Meeting of the Brazilian Finance Society (Curitiba, 2024), LatAm EQDerivatives* (São Paulo, 2024), FinanceHub* (São Paulo, 2024), Insper Macro and Finance Workshop*.* * Presented by a coauthor.

Work in Progress

Equity Options and the Jump Composition of Exchange Rate Variation

Estimating Prices of Risk Nonparametrically

Commodity Risk in Financial Markets, with Josue Costa

Teaching Experience

2026	Teaching Assistant, *Quantitative Finance* (undergraduate), Insper
2026	Teaching Assistant, *Behavioral Economics* (master's), Insper
2024	Teaching Assistant, *Time Series Econometrics* (PhD), Insper

Honors, Awards, and Fellowships

2026	Best Paper Award in Asset Pricing, Brazilian Finance Society *for VIX Futures Term Structure and Currency Returns*
2025	FAPESP PhD Research Internship Abroad Fellowship
2024–2027	FAPESP PhD Fellowship
2024	ANBIMA Capital Markets Prize, Best Finance PhD Thesis Project (BRL 47,600)
2022–2024	Insper PhD Fellowship
2021	Top Performing Undergraduate Student, Insper
2021	Best Undergraduate Paper, Insper

Professional Experience

2023–2025	**Research Assistant**, Center for Finance and Macroeconomics, Insper Built and maintained the center's data repository and constructed return factors in equity, FX, and commodity markets.
2020–2021	**Macroeconomic Research**, Apex Capital, São Paulo Macro-thematic investment research, forecasting of macroeconomic variables, and analysis of the economic and political environment.

Skills and Personal

Programming	R, Python, LaTeX
Data	Bloomberg, LSEG (Refinitiv, Eikon, Datastream), WRDS (CRSP, Compustat, TAQ, OptionMetrics, 13F), intraday FX
Languages	English (fluent), Portuguese (native), Arabic (conversational)
Citizenship	Brazil

Discussions

33rd AEFIN Finance Forum	Fiscal Imbalances and Asset Returns: Cross-Sector Fluctuations under the Aggregate Budget Constraint, by *Alberto Plazzi, Junxiong Gao, Rossen Valkanov and Yan Xu*
32nd AEFIN Finance Forum	On-The-Run Liquidity Phenomenon in the US Treasury Bond Market: A TVP-VAR Analysis, by *Antonio Díaz and Miles Livingston*